



BICOL

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

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PRIMER



THE BICOL RDP 2023-2028



The Bicol Regional Development Plan (RDP) 2023-2028 is the region's blueprint for economic and social transformation to have a prosperous, inclusive, and resilient society. It is the second medium-term plan anchored on the *AmBisyon Natin 2040* representing the collective aspirations of the Filipinos for themselves and the country, to have a “*matatag, maginhawa, at panatag na buhay para sa lahat.*” It is also based on President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.'s eight-point socioeconomic agenda and the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

The planning concept of “Futures Thinking” was adopted in crafting the strategies to address uncertainties in the future. A series of consultations and workshops were conducted to ensure that local aspirations and inclusive development are considered and gain the various stakeholders' ownership, full support, and commitment.

The plan will be implemented through the various programs, activities, and projects (PAPs) of national government agencies (NGAs), local government units (LGUs), and the private sector.

The Regional Development Investment Program (RDIP), an accompanying document of the RDP, will be the source of PAPs for the annual budgets of NGAs.

The Regional Plan Advocacy Committee, an ad-hoc committee of the Bicol RDC will advocate the Bicol RDP 2023-2028 to gain the broadest support and commitment to its implementation.

The performance of the Bicol RDP will be monitored and evaluated using the Result Matrices, Regional Development Report, Regional Project Monitoring and Evaluation System, Regional Statistical Development Program 2024-2029, and other tools and reports.

CHAPTER 1

Overview of the Regional Economy, Development Context, and Trends

Before the COVID-19 pandemic, Bicol Region was among the fastest growing economies in the country, with GRDP growing from 7.2 percent in 2016 to 8.2 percent in 2019. This reduced the proportion of poor families from 31 percent in 2015 to 20 percent in 2018, and the proportion of poor population from 39.8 percent to 27 percent.

In 2020, GRDP decreased by negative 8.3 percent, but posted a positive growth of 4.3 percent in 2021. The proportion of poor families and poor population increased to 21.9 percent and 29.3 percent in 2021, respectively.

Since 2011, employment rate was highest in 2016 at 95.7 percent and lowest in 2020 at 90.4 percent. Underemployment rate decreased from 35.4 percent in 2011 to 27.6 percent in 2020, indicating improvement in the quality of work.

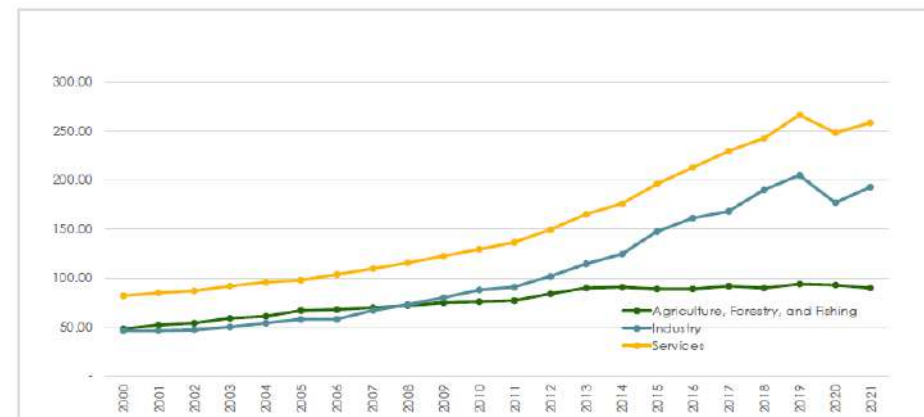
Bicol's economy is driven by the services sector, with a 48 percent share to GRDP in

2021, followed by the industry sector with 35 percent, and the agriculture, fishery and forestry (AFF) sector with 17 percent. In the past two decades, the AFF sector's share was second to services, but because of its sluggish growth, it was overtaken by the industry sector starting in 2008.

Bicol's population reached 6.08 million in 2020, which is 5.6 percent of the country's population and the sixth highest population among 17 regions. Average population density is 350 persons per square kilometer. Male-female ratio is 103:100. Productive population (15-64 years) constitutes 60 percent of the total, while the young dependents (0-14 years) comprise 34 percent and the old dependents (≥ 65 years) comprise six percent.

The region is exposed to natural hazards, i.e., tropical cyclones, flood, landslides, and lahar. Out of 3,471 barangays, 489 are geographically isolated and disadvantaged as of 2020, the second highest among regions.

GRDP in the Bicol Region by Industry of Origin, 2000-2021, in Billion Pesos, at Constant 2018 Prices



Data source: PSA

CHAPTER 2

Regional Spatial Development Framework

The Bicol Regional Physical Framework Plan (RFPF) 2021-2050 provides the spatial development framework to guide the growth of sub-regional areas and the utilization of the region's physical resources.

Consistent with the Luzon Spatial Development Framework, the Bicol RFPF adopted these core strategies:

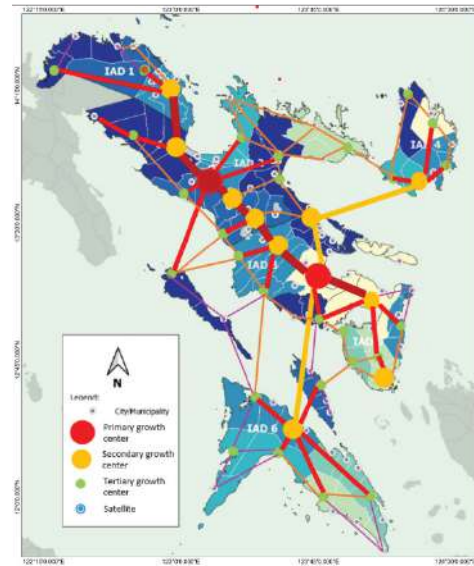
- **Concentration** of settlements and production areas to create agglomeration and economies of scale, promote innovation and smart growth, and reduce encroachment into agricultural, protected, and hazardous areas;
- **Connectivity** to improve linkages between settlements and production areas, urban and rural areas, and between regions, and increase redundancy of transport routes and other infrastructure facilities; and
- **Vulnerability reduction** to reduce the risks and negative impacts of disasters and climate change.

A network of growth centers will be developed with the Cities of Naga and Legazpi as the primary growth areas, the provincial capital towns as secondary growth centers, municipalities grouped into sub-integrated area development (SIAD) as tertiary growth centers, and the other towns as satellite centers.

Spatial development strategies are grouped into four thematic areas:

- **Protection Land Use** to rehabilitate and conserve critical ecosystems, and protect the population from natural hazards;
- **Production Land Use** to efficiently utilize and manage land and water resources, and sustainably meet the demand of the regional population and economy;

Network of Growth Centers in Bicol Region



Map source: DENR. The data on network centers are a product of analysis by NEDA.

- **Settlements Development** to create disaster-resilient and climate-smart communities in identified growth areas by providing social, economic, and infrastructure facilities and services; and
- **Infrastructure Development** to provide green and smart infrastructure facilities and improve physical and digital connectivity among the protection, production, and settlement areas.

In view of an increasingly volatile, uncertain, complex, and ambiguous (VUCA) environment, the long-term RFPF preparation process integrated futures thinking and strategic foresight to come up with four scenarios. The development challenges generated from these scenarios are considered in the medium term Bicol RDP 2023-2028.

CHAPTER 3

Overview of the RDP 2023-2028 Strategy Framework

Through futures thinking and strategic foresight, four scenarios were considered in the long-term Bicol RFPF 2021-2050 and the medium-term Bicol RDP 2023-2028.

In all scenarios, among the challenges that the Bicol RDP needs to address are:

- Ensuring food, water, and energy security;
- Addressing poverty;
- Increasing resiliency;
- Addressing environmental problems;
- Moving towards modernization;
- Enhancing research, development, and innovation; and
- Providing infrastructure facilities and social services.

High levels of inclusive growth will be sustained to attain the Sustainable Development Goals, the *Ambisyon Natin*, and the preferred future of Biophilia (or Sagana). By the end of 2028, Bicol hopes to regain its pre-pandemic status as one of the

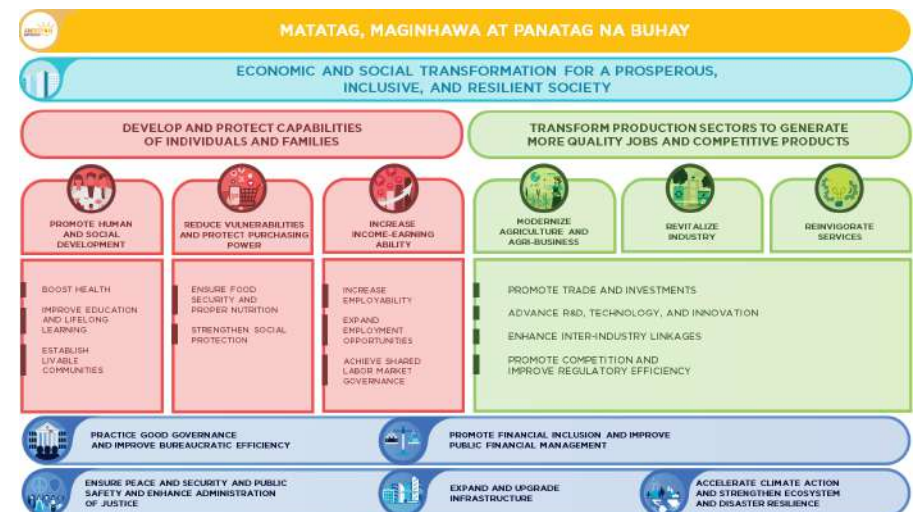
fastest growing regions in the country, as measured by these targets:

- GRDP growth of 7-8.5 percent from 4.3 percent in 2021;
- Poverty incidence of population of 18 percent from 29.3 percent in 2021;
- Unemployment rate of 5-6.5 percent from 8.8 percent in 2021; and
- Inflation rate of 2-4 percent from 7.2 percent in December 2021.

To achieve the targets, the Bicol RDP's goal is economic and social transformation for a prosperous, inclusive, and resilient society. The strategies are organized along three objectives:

- Develop and protect capabilities of individuals and families;
- Transform productive sectors to generate more quality jobs and competitive products; and
- Foster an enabling environment.

Bicol RDP 2023-2028 Strategic Framework





CHAPTER 4

Promote Human & Social Development

Pangalagaan ang Tao. Iangat ang Pamilyang Bikolano.

Chapter 4.1: Boost Health

The COVID-19 pandemic highlighted the vulnerabilities of the healthcare system, such as inadequate access to primary healthcare, insufficient healthcare workers, and limited investment in health systems.

Long-standing gaps in the health system will be addressed through more equitable outcomes, responsive health systems, and improved financial risk protection.

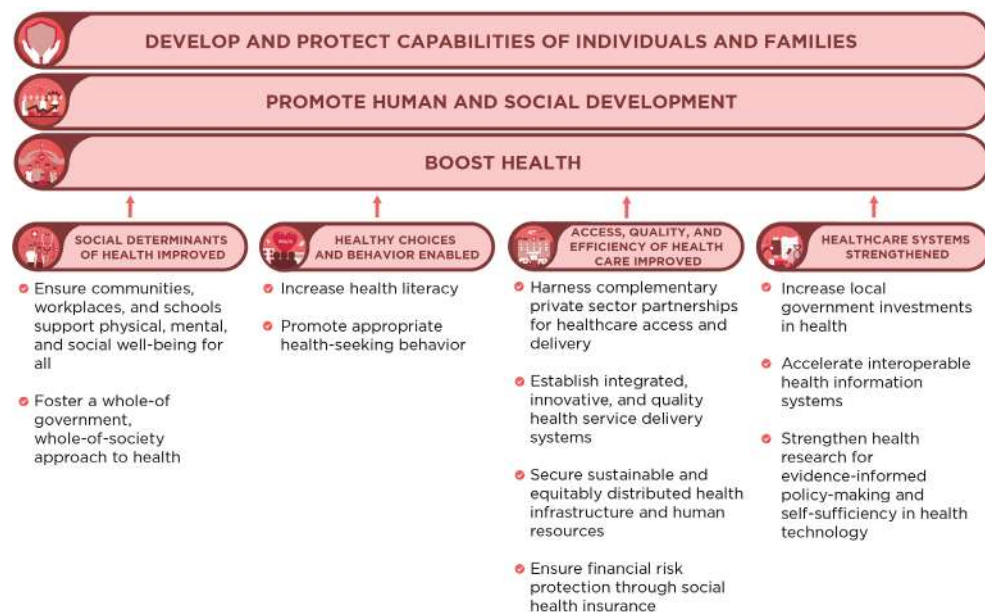
The targets are to achieve health equity and promote good health through comprehensive healthcare strategies focusing on an

integrated network of healthcare providers, an advanced healthcare delivery system, sustained investment in health resources, and harmonized efforts of all sectors.

The strategy framework supports the whole-of-society approach to achieve these outcomes:

- Social determinants of health improved;
- Healthy choices and behavior enabled;
- Access, quality, and efficiency of healthcare improved; and
- Healthcare systems strengthened.

Strategy Framework to Boost Health



Chapter 4.2: Improve Education & Lifelong Learning

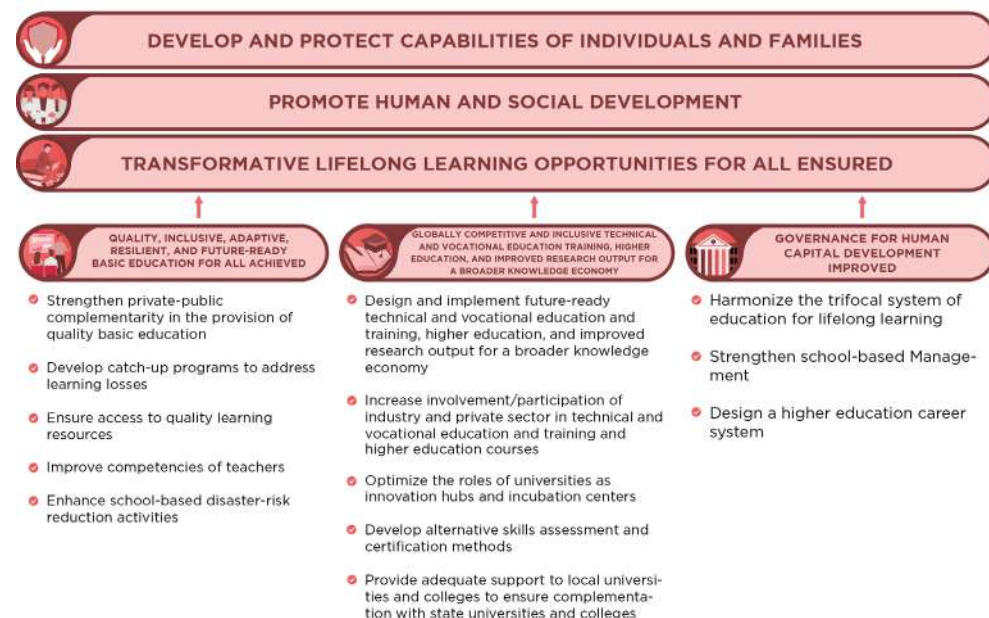
Different learning modalities were implemented in view of the Covid-19 pandemic, but student learning outcomes need to be assessed.

The targets are to improve the quality of education and expand access to lifelong learning opportunities through enhanced curriculum, improved access to quality learning resources, strengthened competencies of teachers, improved learners' proficiency, promotion of knowledge co-creation, and establishment of innovation centers.

The strategy framework seeks to achieve these outcomes:

- Quality, inclusive, adaptive, resilient, and future-ready basic education for all achieved;
- Globally competitive technical and vocational education and training, higher education, and improved research output for a broader knowledge economy; and
- Governance for human capital development improved.

Strategy Framework to Improve Education and Lifelong Learning



CHAPTER 5

Reduce Vulnerabilities & Protect Purchasing Power



Pangalagaan ang Tao. Iangat ang Pamilyang Bikolano.

Chapter 4.3: Establish Livable Communities

Persistent challenges include reducing the unmet housing needs for informal settler families, increasing the number of local government units with local shelter plans, and decreasing the housing backlog.

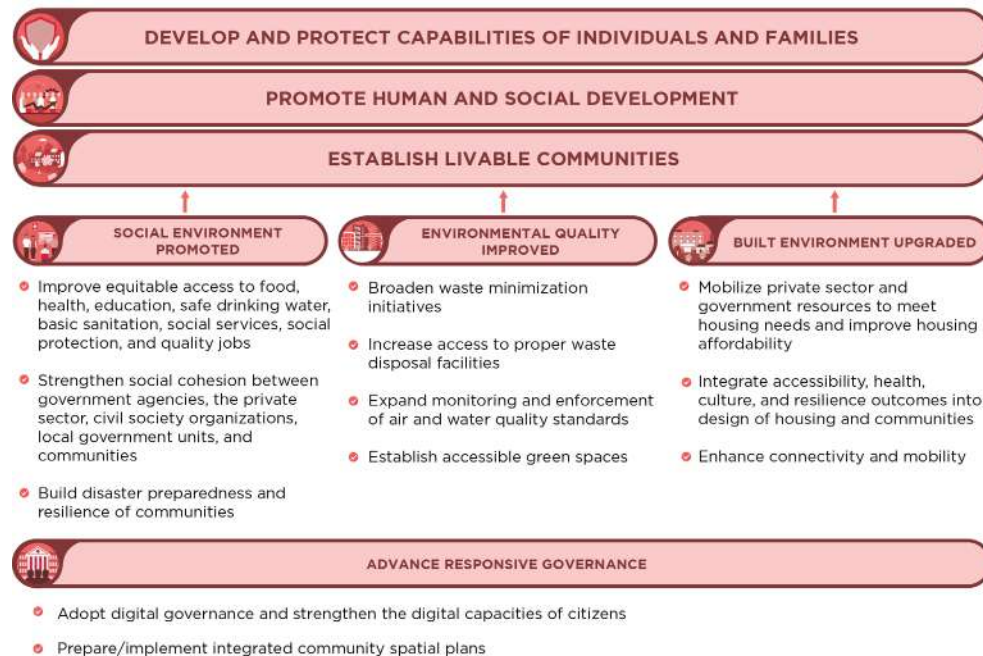
The target is to establish livable communities and upgrade conditions of existing communities where all residents equitably access civic, social, and socioeconomic opportunities through the availability of basic services and facilities, improved environmental quality, enhanced mobility and connectivity, and responsive governance.

This chapter is guided by the Bicol RPPF 2021-2050 core strategies of concentration, connectivity, and vulnerability reduction. A network of growth centers will be developed and the islands of Catanduanes and Masbate will be self-sufficient and have improved digital and physical connectivity.

The strategy framework seeks to achieve these outcomes:

- Social environment promoted;
- Environmental quality improved; and
- Built environment upgraded.

Strategy Framework to Establish Livable Communities



Achieving the Bicolanos' desire for a stable and high level of well-being entails protecting their purchasing power by ensuring food security and proper nutrition, and reducing their vulnerabilities by strengthening social protection.

Among the targets to ensure food security and proper nutrition are to reduce the food

inflation rate, lower the subsistence incidence among the population and the prevalence of malnutrition among children

To strengthen social protection, among the targets are to increase the number of families covered by social insurance, and expand the coverage of social protection programs.



(top) Strategy Framework to Ensure Food Security and Proper Nutrition
(bottom) Strategy Framework to Strengthen Social Protection





CHAPTER 6

Increase Income-Earning Ability

Pangalagaan ang Tao. Iangat ang Pamilyang Bikolano.

Building on the gains from technological advancements, the generation of productive employment opportunities will be sustained to improve the well-being of individuals and families. Providing decent jobs will increase the income of Bicolanos, especially the poor and vulnerable groups. Skills enhancement will be prioritized to enable Bicolanos to take full advantage of their potential.

Among the targets are: (a) 70 percent of technical and vocational education and training graduates in programs with training

regulations are certified within five days after graduation; (b) 90 percent of skilled workers issued with certification within seven days of their application; and (c) 69 percent of graduates from TESDA scholarship programs are employed.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Employability increased;
- Access to employment opportunities expanded; and
- Shared labor market governance achieved.

Strategy Framework to Increase Income-earning Ability



CHAPTER 7

Modernize Agriculture & Agri-Business

Makabagong Produkto Dekalidad na Serbisyo para sa Kaunlaran ng Bikolano.

The agri-fishery sector faces long standing challenges, such as improving farm and labor productivity, increasing investments in research and development, and enhancing resiliency.

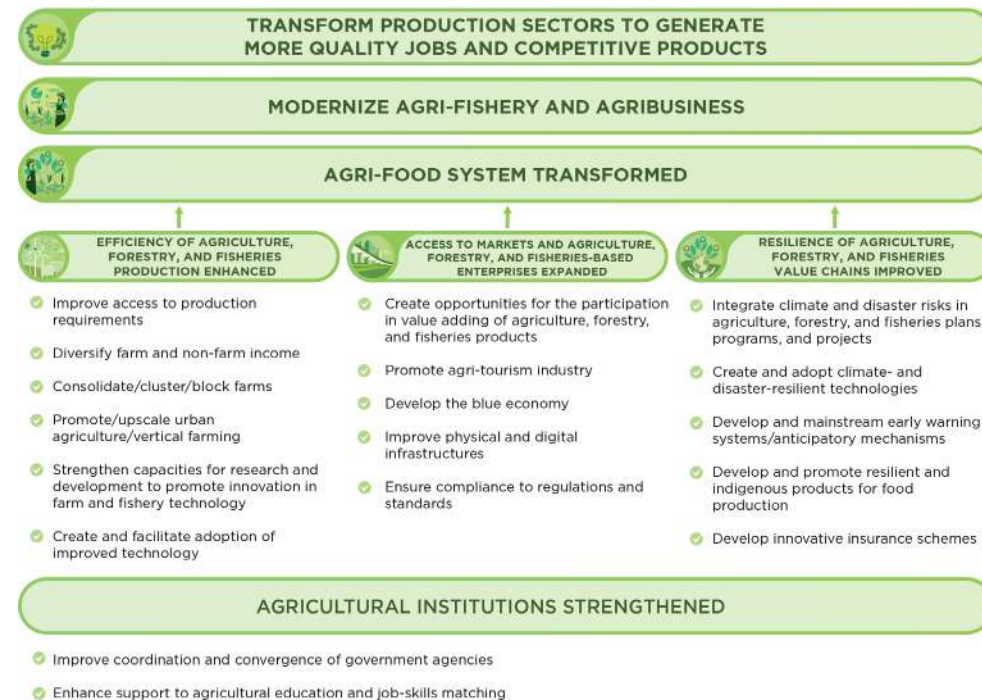
Among the targets are to increase the: (a) growth in gross value added in agriculture, forestry, and fishery (AFF) from 0.8 percent in 2022 to a range of 1.8-3.3 percent; (b) AFF labor productivity; (c) level of rice mechanization; (d) growth in value of

agri-fishery exports; and (e) proportion of primary producers covered by agricultural insurance.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Efficiency of AFF production enhanced;
- Access to markets and AFF-based enterprises expanded;
- Resilience of AFF value chains improved; and
- Agricultural institutions strengthened.

Strategy Framework to Modernize Agriculture and Agri-Business





CHAPTER 8 Revitalize Industry

*Makabagong Produkto Dekalidad na Serbisyo
para sa Kaunlaran ng Bikolano.*

The industry sector will be revived to produce more high quality jobs and competitive products. This will be done by expanding the domestic market, advancing the value chain, strengthening cross-sectoral ties, and making science, technology, and innovation a way of life of industry players.

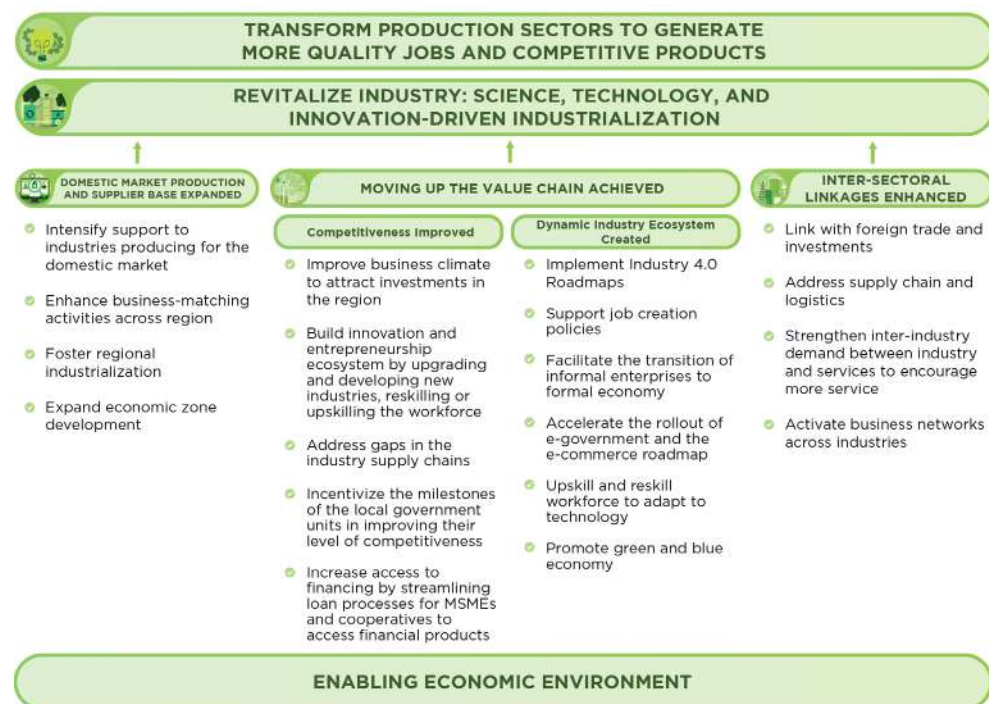
Among the targets are: (a) sustain the growth in gross value added in the industry sector from 8.8 percent in 2021 to a range of

8-9.5 percent; and (b) increase employment generated in the industry sector from 35 thousand in 2022 to 46.9 thousand in 2028.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Domestic market production and supplier base expanded;
- Moving up the value chain achieved; and
- Inter-sectoral linkages enhanced.

Strategy Framework to Revitalize Industry



CHAPTER 9 Reinvalidate Services

*Makabagong Produkto Dekalidad na Serbisyo
para sa Kaunlaran ng Bikolano.*

The services sector will become modern, effective, and resilient through higher value-adding and improved services and the entry of new key players. Market expansion and digital transformation will strengthen the businesses' market positions, expand new customer regions and market categories, and explore diversification.

Tourism will continue to drive growth in other services subsectors, such as accommodation and food services, trade, transportation, communication, and business services.

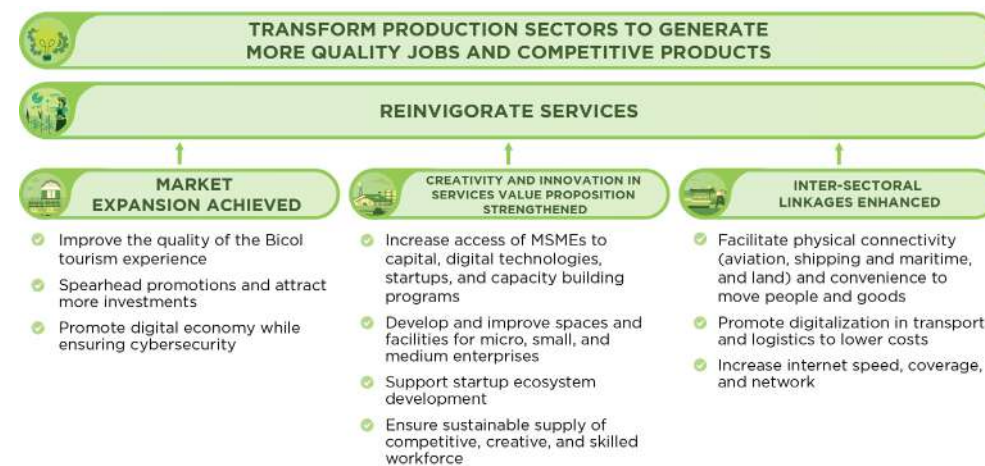
Among the targets are to increase the: (a)

growth in gross value added in the services sector from 3.9 percent in 2021 to a range of 6.4-7.9 percent; (b) foreign tourist arrival from .008 million in 2022 to 0.267 million in 2028; and (c) domestic tourist arrival from 0.98 million to 8.305 million in the same period.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Market expansion achieved;
- Creativity and innovation in services value proposition strengthened; and
- Inter-sectoral linkages enhanced.

Strategy Framework to Reinvalidate Services





CHAPTER 10

Advance Research & Development, Technology, & Innovation

Makabagong Produkto Dekalidad na Serbisyo para sa Kaunlaran ng Bikolano.

Research and development (R&D), technology and innovation will drive future growth, reinvigorate job and income generation, and increase the resiliency of production sectors of the economy.

Among the targets are to increase the number of: (a) university-industry collaborations on R&D; (b) researchers with full-time equivalent; and (c) innovation hubs, technology business incubators, and start-ups.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Basic R&D and knowledge creation strengthened;
- Market-driven and customer-centered R&D advanced;
- Technology extension, adoption, utilization, and commercialization scaled up; and
- Innovation and entrepreneurship accelerated.

Strategy Framework to Advance Research and Development, Technology, and Innovation



CHAPTER 11

Promote Trade & Investments

Makabagong Produkto Dekalidad na Serbisyo para sa Kaunlaran ng Bikolano.



The trade and investment sector is one of the region's economic drivers, as it fuels job creation, skills development, and poverty reduction.

Focus will be given to the survival, growth, and expansion of local firms in the region catering to domestic and international markets to drive productive employment and increase incomes.

Among the targets are to increase the: (a) merchandise exports in the region; (b)

services exports; (c) number of marketing and promotional activities of Bicol goods and services; and (d) number and investments of registered stock and non-stock corporations.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Global position of Philippine export sectors restored, sustained, and strengthened; and
- Total investments increased and targeted to boost trade, skills upgrading, and sustainability.

Strategy Framework to Promote Trade and Investments





CHAPTER 12

Promote Financial Inclusion & Improve Public Financial Management

Mataas na Kalidad ng Paggobyerno na may Payapa at Ligtas na Komunidad para sa Likas-Kayang Pag-Unlad

A strong public financial management system improves public service. Financial inclusion contributes to reducing inequality and improving the well-being of the poor. For financial institutions, this will increase overall savings rates, loans, and accounts.

Among the targets are to: (a) increase the proportion of adults with access to financial services; (b) improve financial inclusivity of the lower income classes; (c) increase the number of financial technology companies

in the region; and (d) increase the locally-sourced income of local government units.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Financial inclusion broadened and deepened;
- Financial innovation accelerated and strengthened;
- An efficient and inclusive budget system implemented; and
- Local government finance strengthened.

Strategy Framework to Promote Financial Inclusion and Improve Public Financial Management



CHAPTER 13

Expand & Upgrade Infrastructure

Mataas na Kalidad ng Paggobyerno na may Payapa at Ligtas na Komunidad para sa Likas-Kayang Pag-Unlad



Infrastructure is the backbone of regional development as it supports sustainable economic and social development. Building sustainable, resilient, integrated, and modern infrastructure facilities and services will help attain the medium-term goal of economic and social transformation for a prosperous, inclusive, and resilient society.

The chapter focuses on digital and transport connectivity, water security, clean energy, and adequate social infrastructure.

Among the targets are: (a) new roads constructed to close the gaps in the national road network; (b) increased length of paved national roads; (c) increased volume of air and sea passenger and cargo traffic; (d) increased average broadband and download speed; (e) increased proportion of households with internet connection; (f) increased proportion of families with access to safe water and basic sanitation; (g) increased ratio of irrigated area to potential irrigable area; (h) increased number of

households safe from flood and storm surge; (i) increased electricity consumption per capita; (j) increased share of renewable energy in generation mix and installed capacity; (k) increased classroom-pupil, water and sanitation facility-pupil, and rural health unit-population ratios; (l) increased number of socialized lot and housing units produced and taken out; (m) increased number of local government units with materials recovery facilities, approved solid waste management plans, and served with sanitary landfills.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

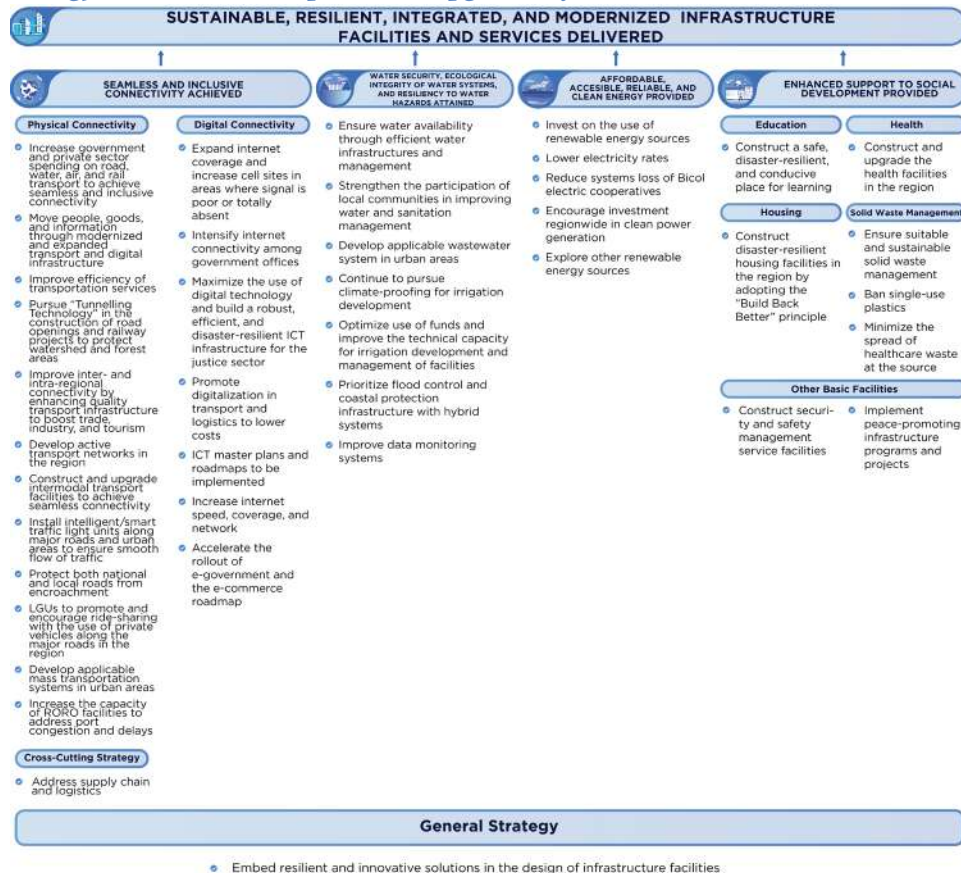
- Seamless and inclusive physical and digital connectivity achieved;
- Water security, ecological integrity of water systems, and resiliency to water hazards attained;
- Affordable, accessible, reliable, and clean energy provided; and
- Enhanced support to social development provided.

Ensure Peace & Security, & Enhance Administration of Justice

Mataas na Kalidad ng Paggobyerno na may Payapa at Ligtas na Komunidad para sa Likas-Kayang Pag-Unlad



Strategy Framework to Expand and Upgrade Infrastructure



Peace and security, and an efficient administration of justice are critical in providing an enabling environment to achieve the regional development objectives.

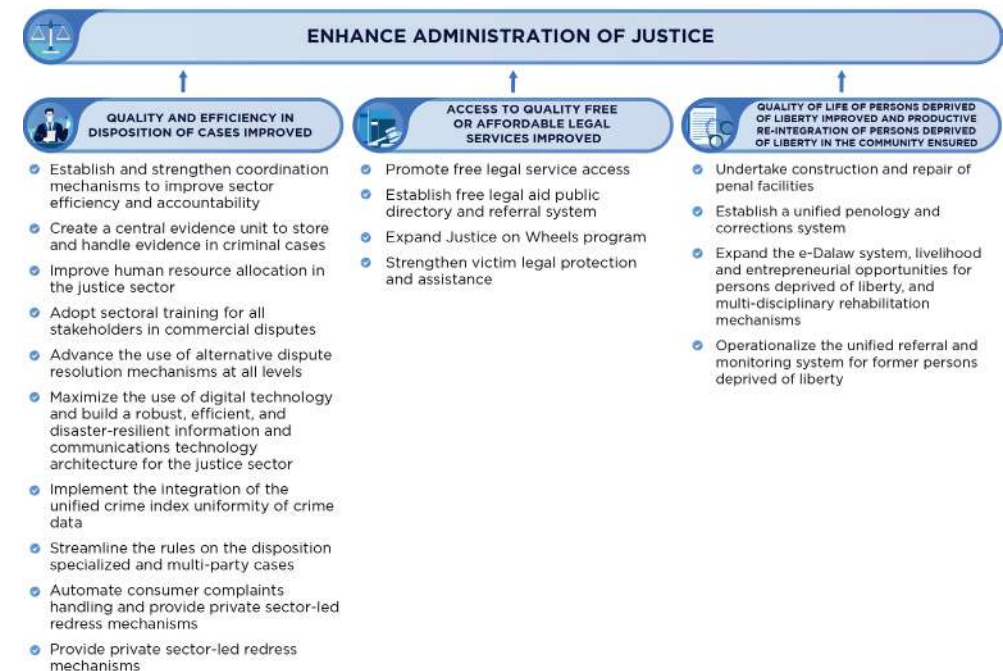
A whole-of-government approach to strengthen peacekeeping and peacebuilding efforts will help achieve lasting peace and security. A stable and accountable justice system will inspire trust and confidence among stakeholders.

Among the targets are: (a) reduced average monthly index crime rate; (b) increased percentage of cybercrime incident reports processed and remediated; (c) increased completion rate of cases; and (d) reduced average congestion rate in prison facilities.

The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Development of conflict-affected communities and conflict-vulnerable areas sustained;
- Quality of life of people safeguarded from criminality;
- Safety from natural hazards and other security threats ensured;
- Quality and efficiency in disposition of cases improved;
- Access to quality free or affordable legal services improved; and
- Quality of life of persons deprived of liberty improved and their productive re-integration in the community ensured.

Strategy Framework to Enhance Administration of Justice

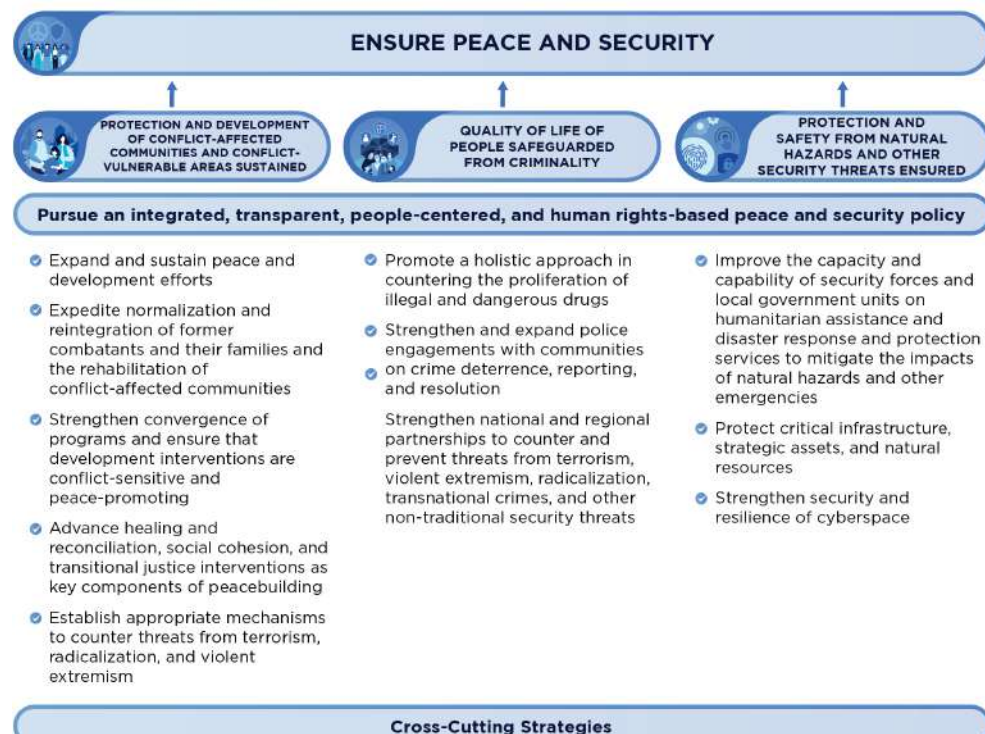


Practice Good Governance & Improve Bureaucratic & Regulatory Efficiency

Mataas na Kalidad ng Paggobyerno na may Payapa at Ligtas na Komunidad para sa Likas-Kayang Pag-Unlad



Strategy Framework to Ensure Peace and Security



Good governance, characterized by accountability, transparency, and efficiency, is the foundation for inclusive growth and a high-trust society.

This chapter presents strategies to attain clean and efficient governance, to promote stronger collaboration between regional line agencies and local government units, and to improve regulatory efficiency and competitiveness.

Among the targets are: (a) increased percentage of local government units (LGUs) compliant with local development council standards and the full disclosure policy; (b) increased percentage of administrative case disposition and case resolution rates; (c) increased percentage of LGUs conferred

with Seal of Good Local Governance and recognized in the Cities and Municipalities Competitiveness Index survey; (d) increased number of agencies with PRIME-HRM Bronze award; and (e) increased number of Negosyo Centers and LGUs with integrated business permits and licensing systems. The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Participatory governance deepened;
- Public accountability and integrity bolstered;
- Government functions, systems, and mechanisms rationalized and strengthened
- Competent, motivated, agile, and resilient public servants supported; and
- Regulatory burden on businesses and individuals reduced.

Strategy Framework to Practice Good Governance and Improve Bureaucratic and Regulatory Efficiency





CHAPTER 16

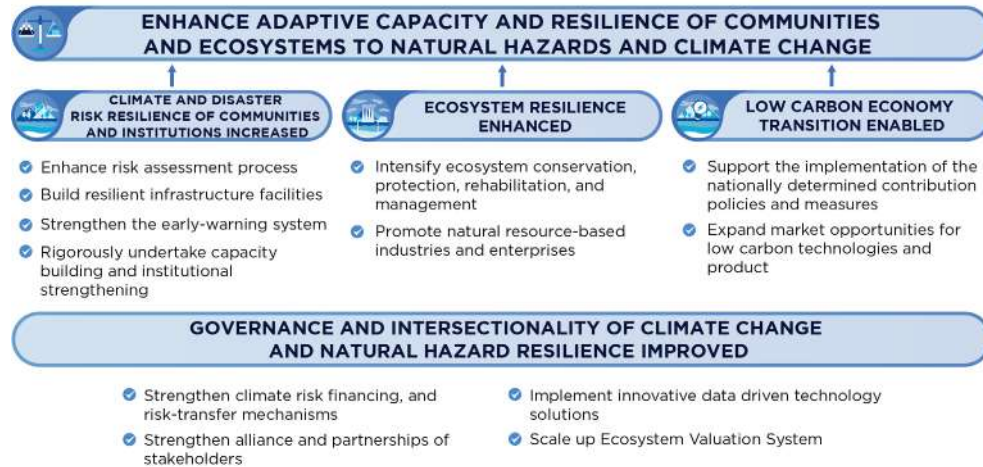
Accelerate Climate Action & Strengthen Ecosystem & Disaster Resilience

Mataas na Kalidad ng Paggobyerno na may Payapa at Ligtas na Komunidad para sa Likas-Kayang Pag-Unlad

The challenges brought by climate change emphasize the need for collective action to build resilient institutions, communities, and ecosystems.

Among the targets are: (a) zero casualties (death, injured, and missing) during disasters; (b) forest cover increased; (c) mitigated greenhouse gas emissions increased; and (d) participation of peoples and civil society organizations in development bodies increased.

Strategy Framework to Enhance Adaptive Capacity and Resilience of Communities and Ecosystems to Climate Change and Natural Hazards



The strategy framework seeks to attain these outcomes:

- Climate and disaster risk resilience of communities and institutions enhanced
- Ecosystem resilience enhanced;
- Low carbon economy transition enabled; and
- Governance and intersectionality of climate change and natural hazard resilience improved.

CHAPTER 17

Plan Implementation, Monitoring, & Evaluation



Policy Formulation & Project Development

The set of policies and regional priorities were determined in the RDP under each chapter. Initial policies that will support and usher in new strategies have been identified, and new policies will be formulated and advocated by the RDC in Congress, as necessary.

To ensure a more focused, integrated, cohesive, and convergent implementation of various PAPs, the Operational Plan will be prepared.

All concerned duty bearers will adhere to the processes involved in policy formulation and project development, taking into account all aspects including the social, environmental, economic, and political points of view. Cross-cutting concerns were considered in the planning stage and the same parameters will be used in the early project development stage.

Investment Programming & Financing

PAPs will be reviewed and evaluated by the concerned RDC sectoral committees for endorsement to the RDC for appropriate action. Subsequently, viable PAPs duly approved by the Bicol RDC will be integrated into the RDIP, the accompanying document of the RDP, for funding and implementation. The RDIP is a dynamic document where PAPs are updated and revalidated annually to ensure consistency with the national and regional development priorities. The annual time slice will be taken as the Annual Investment Program that serves as the basis for the annual budgets of the different agencies and SUCs.

Funding for the implementation of the government's PAPs will be sourced from the GAA, Official Development Assistance, corporate funds of GOCCs, GFIs, and locally generated revenues. The private sector will be tapped for PPP projects or joint venture agreements with the LGUs.

Plan Implementation

Policies, programs, activities, and projects (P/PAPs) will be undertaken by concerned stakeholders, with close coordination in place especially for big-ticket and inter-sectoral P/PAPs. Implementation status will be monitored, and project impacts will be assessed to determine project efficiency and effectiveness in contributing to the various strategies, and ultimately, to the sub-sector and sector outcomes, and the RDP intermediate goal.

Monitoring & Evaluation

The progress of the government's interventions, periodic reviews, and evaluations will be regularly monitored using existing monitoring and evaluation mechanisms, such as the Results Matrix, Regional Project Monitoring and Evaluation System, Regional Development Report, Regional Statistical Development Program 2024-2029, and other reports and tools.

Advocacy

The Regional Plan Advocacy Committee, an ad hoc committee of the Bicol RDC and chaired and co-chaired by PIA 5 and DILG 5, respectively, will lead the advocacy of the Bicol RDP 2023-2028 implementation among regional government entities, LGUs, private sector and CSOs, the academe, media partners, and the public. The effective implementation of the RDP calls for efficient coordination and collaboration between and among all stakeholders.

Midterm Review & Updating

The Bicol RDC will lead the midterm review and updating of the RDP 2023-2028 in 2025 to assess its performance and come up with catch-up strategies to achieve the desired outcomes.



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